

# “THERE WILL BE NO WHITEWASH AT THE WHITE HOUSE.”

Richard Nixon, US president, in a TV speech on Watergate, April 30, 1973

The White House, the official residence of the US President, was rocked by the Watergate scandal and the subsequent resignation of President Nixon.

ON JANUARY 30, SEVEN MEN WERE CONVICTED of breaking into the Democratic Party's Watergate headquarters in Washington, DC and bugging it. President Nixon, who had just been reelected, continually denied any connection between Watergate and the White House. However, *Washington Post* reporters Bob Woodward and Carl Bernstein brought to light the president's involvement in the bugging, which would eventually lead to his impeachment and resignation from office (see 1974). Their work on the "Watergate scandal," helped by crucial information from the mysterious informant, "Deep Throat," led to the *Washington Post* being awarded the Pulitzer Prize.



## Allende's reforms

The Chilean president's sweeping nationalization and reforms resulted in costly welfare schemes and economic chaos in the country.

In a landmark judgement referred to as the **Roe v. Wade** case, the Supreme Court legalized abortions in the US. The ruling came after Norma McCorvey, under the pseudonym "Jane Roe," challenged the criminal abortion laws in Texas.

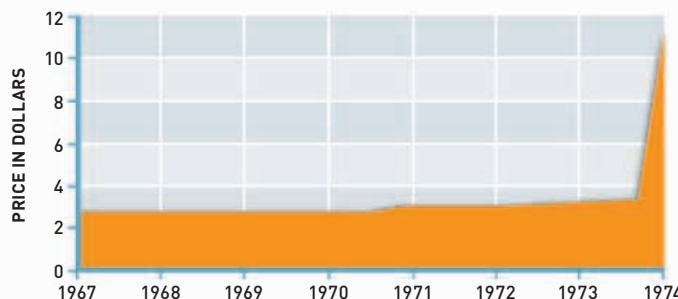
The Vietnam war was officially over for the US, when it signed a ceasefire agreement in January after months of talks in Paris.

Britain, Ireland, and Denmark became full-fledged members of the European Economic Community (EEC) in January, bringing the number of member states to nine. It was the first enlargement of the organization since its inception in 1957.

The IRA extended its bombing campaign in mainland Britain. On September 8, there were bombs in Manchester city center and at Victoria station, London. Two days later, explosions ripped through King's Cross and Euston stations. On November 14, an IRA gang was convicted of the bombings.

In September, Chilean president Salvador Allende (1908–73) was killed in a coup led by his trusted ally General Augusto Pinochet (1915–2006), and backed by the US. Pinochet killed 3,000 supporters of the Allende regime, shut the Chilean Parliament, and banned all political activity. In 1974, he made himself president (see 1998).

In December, the Basque separatist movement, ETA, killed Spanish prime minister Admiral Luis Carrero Blanco in Madrid, in retaliation for the execution of Basque militants (see 1959).



## Costing dear

When OPEC shut off oil supplies to the western nations that had supported Israel, it sent prices shooting up from less than \$3 a barrel to \$11 in a matter of weeks.

Heavy fighting broke out between Arab and Israeli forces in what came to be known as the Yom Kippur War, in October. Egyptian forces broke the Israeli line on the eastern bank of the Suez Canal, and in the north, Syrian troops battled with Israeli defenses along the Golan Heights, seized by Israel from Syria in 1967. A peace

deal, signed on November 11 between Egypt and Israel, ended the strife. Following the war, the Arab oil-producing countries imposed an oil embargo on all the countries that had supported Israel. In October, oil prices soared around the world, from under \$3 a barrel before the war to over \$11 by early 1974.

## THE POLITICS OF OIL

The Arab oil embargo caused global chaos. The Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) switched off supply at a time when the market was already starting to suffer shortages. The crisis revealed oil as a powerful political weapon. Countries in the Middle East were seen to have acquired control of a vital commodity, and Western nations were vulnerable because they relied on oil imports.



Emperor of Ethiopia, Haile Selassie, had been crowned "King of Kings."

THE OIL EMBARGO OF 1973 HAD A DRASTIC EFFECT on the developed world, leading to a long-term recession. Unemployment and inflation soared, and stock markets crashed globally.

In Portugal, General Antonio de Spínola (1910–96) led a bloodless military coup, ending 50 years of dictatorship. Known as the Carnation Revolution, this event ushered in a new era of democracy in the country.

In Britain, the IRA attacked the Houses of Parliament on June 17, the Tower of London in July, and a Guildford pub in October.

In July, Turkish troops invaded northern Cyprus following a coup in which President Archbishop Makarios, a Greek Cypriot, was deposed. The island was split in two parts, with Greek-Cypriots fleeing to the south and the Turkish community, to the north.

After years of war and famine in Ethiopia, Emperor Haile Selassie (1892–1975) was overthrown in a coup, on September 12. General Tafari Benti (1921–77) became head of state.

In the US, the Watergate breakin (see 1973) was traced to a Nixon support group. In July, the Supreme Court ordered Nixon to turn over the tape recordings relating to the scandal. He was impeached, and resigned from office in August.

Disco, a genre of dance music that had started in the clubs of New York in the late 1960s, peaked at this time with new music, polyester suits, and films such as *Saturday Night Fever*.

January 1 Britain, Denmark, and Norway join EEC

January 22 Former US President Lyndon Johnson dies (b. 1908)

January 23 Ceasefire agreed in Vietnam

March IRA bombs central London

February 24 down Libyan passenger plane

March 7 Sheikh Mujibur Rahman is first prime minister of Bangladesh

March 26 British playwright Noel Coward dies (b. 1899)

May 14 Skylab, first US Space Station, is launched

April 4 World Trade Center, world's tallest building, is built

April 8 Death of artist Pablo Picasso (b. 1881)

July 10 Bahamas gains independence from Britain

September 28 Sydney Opera House opens in Australia

May 17 US Senate hears Watergate case

October 16 OPEC declares oil embargo on Western nations

September 11 Chilean president, Salvador Allende, assassinated (b. 1908)

October 6 Yom Kippur War begins

November 25 Greek army seizes power in Athens

February 8 Raymond Damadian develops Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) in the US

April 2 Death of Georges Pompidou, the president of France (b. 1911)

July 20 Turkey invades Northern Cyprus

August 8 President Nixon resigns after Watergate scandal